



Tricks to be a Sharp Shooter

- Brace yourself and avoid excessive hand movement to get those sharp photos. The camera needs to be stable to get a good focus, and adjust the white balance and metering.
- When on the road, remember to carry many sets of batteries or invest in rechargeable ones—digital cameras have a way of chewing through batteries and you wouldn't want to miss a great photo opportunity.
- Use the flash wisely. In bright sunlight, where parts of your subject might be darker, use 'flash fill' to brighten up the darker areas for a balanced photo. Flashes only have a range of up to 10–12 feet so don't bother using it for objects farther than this. Use red-eye reduction to get rid of the monster-glow eyes.
- The overall tone of a photo looks different in certain kinds of lighting. Experiment with the white balance and if you want more

natural colours, manually set the white balance to match the scene before you shoot.

■ For portrait shots, eliminate a 'crowded' background, as this tends to take away the attention from the subject. Either move to a more neutral background or adjust the f-stops to the widest setting possible so that the background is as out of focus as possible—this creates stunning clarity for the main subject.

■ Use the Flash-fill mode, especially when shooting portraits as this eliminates harsh shadows on the subject. Avoid such shots at high noon as this creates very harsh shadows.

■ Flash reflectors are great for filling out harsh shadows. You can use a simple car window reflector as a flash reflector or even a white card that's about 2 square feet. Reflect light on the subject's face to eliminate shadows and you will have great portraits.

on the flower, all the cameras were able to achieve this without a problem with the Olympus Camedia 2100 Ultra Zoom and Fuji FinePix A201 exhibiting breathtaking clarity.

The three cameras in this category that were not able to pick up the detail of the text on the spine of the book were the Casio QV-2800UX, the Kodak EasyShare DX3600 and the Sony CyberShot DSC-P31. These cameras registered an unreadable blur while the others were able to pick up this detail well.

The lace details on the background of the image was also faithfully picked up by all the cameras without a hitch. Finally, all cameras in this category except the Kodak EasyShare DX3600, the Sony CyberShot DSC-P31 and the Casio QV-2800UX were able to pick up the details on the fruit.

Specular effect and gradation in shading: For this test we noted two interesting effects in the test scene—the specular effect (light shining off metallic surfaces) and gradations in shading in the scene.

In the sub-2.0 megapixel category, the Fuji FinePix A101 returned a very good specular effect on the spectacles and the metallic binder on the desktop calendar. The Kodak EasyShare DX3215 was perfect as far as gradation in shading went but

sub-2.0 megapixel category but was unable to pick up the droplets of water on the flower reliably. Also, the overall image looked slightly washed out and lighter than the original as compared to the other cameras.

We then evaluated the capability of the camera to pick up the text on the spine of one book (refer to the test scene image). This was a particularly difficult detail to reproduce as it involved picking up very small-sized text. In this category, only the Kodak EasyShare DX3215 was able to successfully show this detail, while this was virtually impossible to read with the rest of the cameras.

The next region we looked at was the design pattern on the lace curtain. We observed this area for signs of the edge of the pattern merging with the adjoining areas. The only cameras in the sub-2.0 megapixel category that did show this properly were the Kodak EasyShare DX3215 and the Fuji FinePix A101.

In the final area, the cameras that could manage to pick up the details of the fruit were the Kodak EasyShare 3215, the Fuji FinePix A101 and the Casio GV-10.

In the 2+ megapixel category, there was a very noticeable improvement in the performance of the cameras—all of them except the Nikon CoolPix 775 and the Sony CyberShot DSC-P31 were able to pick up the number 16 on the desktop

calendar. The exceptional performer here was the Olympus Camedia C-2100 Ultra Zoom with its 1600x1200 image resolution—the numerals on the calendar were vivid, sharp and clearly readable.

As for picking up the droplets of water

Fuji FinePix A201

Very similar to its predecessor, the FinePix A101, in construction and looks, the Fuji FinePix A201 features an enhanced 2.1 megapixel CCD and a 2.5x digital zoom. This one also uses the same menu structure as the FinePix A101. It has a 1.6-inch TFT and sports a very simple and intuitive approach to controlling the functions and parameters of the camera. It has a 16 MB Smart Media card and is powered by two AA alkaline batteries. This camera can store images at a native resolution of 1600x1200, which allows you to print post card sized images at 300 dpi. These images are stored in JPEG format and are transferred to the computer via the USB interface. You can either use the bundled software to download these images, or simply drag and drop them from Windows Explorer as the camera shows up as a drive when connected! The rest of the controls for zoom, menu navigation and modes of operation (playback, image capture and video capture) are identical to the FinePix A101. Best of all, this one costs just Rs 2,000 more than its predecessor.



Fuji FinePix A201	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty & support	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

All in all, this camera offers good features and image quality.

Price: Rs 19,705

- + Very good image quality, small form factor
- No optical zoom